

Answer Key

Grammar

Third Conditional (unreal past)

We use the third conditional (If + past perfect, ... would/could/might + have + past participle) to talk about an imaginary result of a past situation that did not actually happen.

Üçüncü koşul cümlesini (If + past perfect, ... would/could/might + have + past participle) geçmişte gerçekleşmemiş bir durumun hayali sonucundan bahsetmek için kullanırız.

When? We use it to imagine a different past: a situation that was untrue combined with an unreal result, often to explain regret or an alternative version of events.

Gerçek olmayan bir geçmiş hayal etmek için kullanılır: gerçek dışı bir durum ile hayali bir sonuç birleştirilerek genellikle pişmanlığı veya olayların alternatif bir versiyonunu anlatmak için kullanılır.

Positive

- If + subject + had + past participle, subject + would/could/might + have + past participle.

Negative

- If + subject + hadn't + past participle, subject + wouldn't + have + past participle.

Question

- Would/Could + subject + have + past participle if + subject + had + past participle?

Short answers

- Yes, he would have. / No, she wouldn't have.

Common mistakes

- ~~If I would have known, I would have told you.~~ → **If I had known, I would have told you.**
- ~~If she had study, she would have passed.~~ → **If she had studied, she would have passed.**

1. If they _____ earlier, they would have caught the train.

- a. leave
- b. left
- c. had left ✓
- d. have left

Third conditional if-clause uses had + past participle.

2. She wouldn't have been upset if you _____ (tell) her the truth. **(had told)**

Negative result + condition needs had + past participle.

3. If he had trained harder, he _____ the competition.

- a. wins
- b. would win
- c. would have won ✓
- d. won

Result clause needs would have + past participle.

4. If I would have seen you, I would have said hello. — True / False **(Incorrect — If I had seen you, I would have said hello.)**

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5. Put the words in order: had / if / earlier / we / left / would have arrived / on time / we
If we had left earlier, we would have arrived on time.

6. Rewrite as a third conditional: She didn't study, so she failed the exam. (If she had studied, ...) **If she had studied, she wouldn't have failed the exam.**

7. They _____ (might/win) the match if their best player hadn't been injured. **(might have won)**

Might have + past participle expresses a possible unreal result.

8. Combine into one third conditional sentence: He didn't apologise. She stayed angry. (If he had apologised, ...) **If he had apologised, she wouldn't have stayed angry.**

9. If the weather _____ (not be) so bad, we could have gone hiking instead of staying home. **(hadn't been)**

Negative if-clause needs hadn't + past participle.

Wish + Past Perfect (regrets)

We use wish + subject + had + past participle to express regret about something in the past that we cannot change.

Wish + özne + had + past participle yapısını, değiştiremeyeceğimiz geçmişteki bir durum için pişmanlık ifade etmek amacıyla kullanırız.

When? We use it when we want to say that we would like something in the past to have been different, unlike how it really was.

Geçmişte gerçekte olandan farklı bir şeyin olmasını istediğimizi ifade etmek için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + wish(es) + subject + had + past participle.

Negative

- Subject + wish(es) + subject + hadn't + past participle.

Question

- Do/Does + subject + wish + subject + had + past participle?

Short answers

- Yes, I do. / No, she doesn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~I wish I would have gone to the party.~~ → **I wish I had gone to the party.**
- ~~She wish she had known earlier.~~ → **She wishes she had known earlier.**

1. I wish I _____ harder for the test.

- a. study
- b. studied
- c. had studied ✓
- d. have studied

Wish + past perfect for past regret.

2. They wish they _____ (not sell) their old house. **(hadn't sold)**

Negative regret: wish + hadn't + past participle.

3. He wish he had called his brother. — *True / False* (**Incorrect — He wishes he had called his brother.**)

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4. Rewrite as a regret: She didn't apply for the job, and now she is sorry. (*She wishes ...*) **She wishes she had applied for the job.**

5. We wish we _____ (visit) Istanbul when we were near Turkey. (**had visited**)

Positive regret uses had + past participle after wish.

6. Which sentence correctly expresses a past regret?

- a. I wish I go home earlier.
- b. I wish I went home earlier.
- c. I wish I had gone home earlier. ✓
- d. I wish I have gone home earlier.

Only wish + had + past participle expresses a past regret correctly.

7. Combine into one sentence with wish: He didn't practise. Now he plays badly. (*He wishes ...*) **He wishes he had practised.**

8. I wish I _____ (not lose) touch with my old classmates. (**hadn't lost**)

Negative wish + past perfect for a regret about losing something.

The Letter I Never Sent

Before you read

- What is something you wish you had done differently at school?
- Look at the title. What do you think the writer regrets?

When I was seventeen, my best friend Deniz moved to another city with her family. We promised to write letters every week, but somehow life got busy and I never kept my promise. If I had written to her just once a month, our friendship would have survived the distance. Instead, the letters stopped after only a few weeks, and slowly we lost touch completely.

Last year, I found an old, unfinished letter to Deniz in a box under my bed. I had started it years ago but never finished it, and I never sent it. Reading it again, I realised how much I regretted losing such an important friendship. If I hadn't been so lazy about writing back then, we might still be close friends today. I wish I had understood, at seventeen, how rare a good friendship really is.

This year, I finally decided to do something about it. I found Deniz on social media and sent her a message, admitting that I wished I had kept in touch all those years ago. To my surprise, she replied within a day. She told me that she had often wondered what would have happened if either of us had made more effort. We are now planning to meet for coffee next month, twenty years after we last saw each other.

Looking back, I don't think either of us was a bad friend — we were just young and didn't understand how quickly people can drift apart. If we had known then what we know now, we would have made more time for each other. But I've also learned that it's never too late to fix a mistake from the past, even if it takes twenty years to do it.

1. Why did the writer and Deniz lose touch?

- a. They had an argument.
- b. They stopped writing letters regularly. ✓
- c. Deniz didn't want to be friends anymore.
- d. The writer moved away first.

The text says the letters stopped after only a few weeks.

2. The writer sent the unfinished letter to Deniz years ago. — True / False **(Incorrect — The writer never sent the unfinished letter; she found it later, unsent.)**

3. The writer says: 'I wish I _____ how rare a good friendship really is.' **(had understood)**

Wish + past perfect expresses the writer's past regret.

4. How did Deniz react when the writer contacted her again?

- a. She ignored the message.
- b. She was angry.
- c. She replied quickly and was open to reconnecting. ✓
- d. She said it was too late.

The text says Deniz replied within a day and they are now planning to meet.

5. According to the text, what does the writer believe about fixing past mistakes? Write one sentence using your own words. (The writer believes ...) **The writer believes it is never too late to fix a mistake from the past.**

6. What is the main idea of the last paragraph?

- a. Friendships never last.
- b. People should blame themselves for losing friends.
- c. It's never too late to repair a lost friendship. ✓
- d. Social media is the best way to make new friends.

The final paragraph focuses on the idea that mistakes from the past can still be fixed.

After you read

- Do you agree that it's never too late to fix a friendship? Why or why not?
- Have you ever reconnected with someone from your past? What happened?

What If the Bridge Hadn't Been Built?

Before you read

- Think of one famous building or structure in your city or country. Why is it important?
- What do you think would be different if a famous bridge in your country had never been built?

Every town has a story about a decision that changed everything. In one small coastal town, local leaders had to decide whether to build a bridge connecting it to the mainland. Many people were against the idea; they worried that a bridge would destroy the town's quiet, traditional way of life. If the town council had listened to these voices, the bridge would never have been built.

However, the council decided to go ahead with the project. The bridge opened fifteen years ago, and the town changed completely. Tourists began arriving by car instead of by the old, slow ferry. New hotels, cafés, and shops appeared along the coast. If the bridge hadn't been built, none of this growth would have happened, and the town might still look exactly as it did decades ago.

Not everyone is happy with the changes. Some older residents say that if the town had stayed isolated, it would have kept its peaceful character. They believe the fishing community that once defined the town has been replaced by a tourist economy that cares more about profit than tradition. They often wonder what would have happened if the bridge project had been rejected all those years ago.

Younger residents, on the other hand, tend to see the bridge differently. Many of them would have had to leave the town to find work if the bridge — and the tourism it brought — hadn't been built. For them, the bridge didn't destroy the town; it saved it from slowly disappearing as young people moved away. Both sides agree on one thing: that single decision changed the town's future forever.

1. Why were some people originally against building the bridge?

- a. It was too expensive.
- b. They thought it would destroy the town's traditional way of life. ✓
- c. They didn't trust the council.
- d. There was no need for tourists.

The text says people worried a bridge would destroy the town's quiet, traditional way of life.

2. If the bridge _____ (not/build), the town might still look exactly as it did decades ago. **(hadn't been built)**

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Third conditional negative form: hadn't been + past participle.

3. All residents agree that the bridge was a bad decision. — *True / False* **(Incorrect — Older and younger residents disagree; younger residents generally see the bridge more positively.)**

4. According to younger residents, what would have happened without the bridge?

- a. The town would have grown faster.
- b. Many young people would have had to leave to find work. ✓
- c. Tourism would have increased anyway.
- d. Nothing would have changed.

The text states many young residents would have had to leave the town to find work.

5. Summarise in one sentence how the bridge changed the town's economy. (*The bridge changed the town's economy by ...*) **The bridge turned the town from a fishing community into a tourist economy.**

After you read

- Do you think the council made the right decision? Why or why not?
- Can you think of a real decision in your own country that changed a place forever?

A Conversation About Regrets

Before you listen

- What is one small decision that can change a person's whole future?
- Listen for what each speaker wishes had been different.

1. What does Speaker B regret?

- a. Choosing the wrong sport
- b. Not training harder with his coach ✓
- c. Losing contact with his coach
- d. Playing for the wrong team

Speaker B says he wishes he had trained more and listened to his coach.

2. Speaker B says: 'If I _____ every single day, I could have played for a much better team.' (**had trained**)

Third conditional if-clause: had + past participle.

3. Speaker A regrets studying business at university. — True / False (**Incorrect — Speaker A regrets dropping art classes, not studying business.**)

4. What does Speaker B suggest at the end of the conversation?

- a. Speaker A should quit their job.
- b. Speaker A should take art classes again. ✓
- c. Speaker A should apologise to their teacher.
- d. Speaker A should study business more.

Speaker B says it's not too late to pick art up again.

Transcript (teacher use)

A You look thoughtful. What are you thinking about?

B Honestly, I was just remembering my old football coach. I wish I had listened to him more carefully back then.

A Why? What did he tell you?

B He said if I had trained every single day instead of just three times a week, I could have played for a much better team. I didn't believe him at the time.

A Do you regret not training more?

B A little, yes. If I had trained harder, my whole career in sports might have been completely different. But I don't blame myself too much — I was only sixteen.

A That's true. I have a similar regret, actually. I wish I hadn't dropped my art classes in school.

B Really? Why did you drop them?

A I thought art wasn't a 'serious' subject. If I had continued, I might have studied design at university instead of business.

B Well, it's not too late to pick it up again, you know.

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A You're right. Maybe I should have thought of that sooner!

Revision

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1. If she _____ earlier, she wouldn't have missed the flight.

- a. leaves
- b. left
- c. had left ✓
- d. would leave

Third conditional if-clause: had + past participle.

2. I wish I _____ (not lose) my grandfather's old watch. **(hadn't lost)**

Wish + hadn't + past participle expresses a negative regret.

3. Which word best completes: 'Choosing to study abroad was a real _____ in her life.'

- a. outcome
- b. turning point ✓
- c. circumstance
- d. consequence

'Turning point' describes a moment that changes the direction of someone's life.

4. If I would have known, I wouldn't have said that. — True / False **(Incorrect — If I had known, I wouldn't have said that.)**

5. In the reading 'The Letter I Never Sent', why did the writer and Deniz lose touch?

- a. They argued.
- b. They stopped writing letters regularly. ✓
- c. Deniz didn't like her anymore.
- d. They lived in the same city.

They lost touch because the letters stopped after a few weeks.

6. He _____ (might/pass) the exam if he had studied a little more. **(might have passed)**

Might have + past participle expresses a possible unreal result.

7. In the listening dialogue, what does Speaker A regret?

- a. Studying business
- b. Dropping art classes ✓
- c. Playing football
- d. Missing a competition

Speaker A says they wish they hadn't dropped their art classes.

8. Put the words in order: hadn't / she / if / studied / harder / passed / wouldn't have / she
If she hadn't studied harder, she wouldn't have passed.

9. Rewrite using wish: He didn't call his friend back, and now he regrets it. *(He wishes ...)* **He wishes he had called his friend back.**

10. Which sentence correctly uses the third conditional?

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- ☐ a. If I have more time, I would have travelled.
 - ☐ b. If I had more time, I would travel more.
 - ☒ c. If I had had more time, I would have travelled more. ✓
 - ☐ d. If I had had more time, I travel more.

Correct third conditional: If + past perfect, would have + past participle.

1. 'A single _____ can change the whole direction of a person's life.'

- a. opportunity
- b. decision ✓
- c. circumstance
- d. achievement

'Decision' fits best as the thing that changes life's direction.

2. She always _____ (reflect) on her school years with a smile. **(reflects)**

Present simple form of 'reflect' with third person subject.

3. Which word means 'a chance or possibility to do something'?

- a. consequence
- b. opportunity ✓
- c. influence
- d. risk

'Opportunity' means a chance to do something.

1. If he _____ the warning, he could have avoided the accident.

- a. listens
- b. listened
- c. had listened ✓
- d. would listen

Third conditional if-clause: had + past participle.

2. We wish we _____ (visit) that museum when we had the chance. **(had visited)**

Wish + past perfect for a past regret.

3. I wish I would have known about the exam date earlier. — True / False **(Incorrect — I wish I had known about the exam date earlier.)**

1. According to 'What If the Bridge Hadn't Been Built?', how did tourism change after the bridge opened?

- a. Tourism decreased.
- b. New hotels, cafés and shops appeared. ✓
- c. The town stayed exactly the same.
- d. Only the ferry service grew.

The text says new hotels, cafés and shops appeared along the coast.

2. Younger residents believe the bridge _____ (save) the town from disappearing. **(saved)**

Past simple describes what actually happened, according to younger residents' belief.

1. What advice did Speaker B's coach give him?

- a. To play a different sport
- b. To train every day instead of three times a week ✓
- c. To quit the team
- d. To find a new coach

The coach told him training every day could have led to a better team.